

*Fundulopanchax amieti*

## Amiet's lyretail



**Location** W. Cameroon  
(lower Sanaga system)

**Length** Up to 2¼ in  
(7.5 cm)  
**Weight** Not recorded  
**Sex** Male/Female  
**Status** Endangered



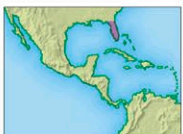
Amiet's lyretail, or Amiet's killifish, remained undescribed until 1976, perhaps because of



its very limited range. It is found in the stoneless, slow-moving, swampy parts of rivers in the rain forests of Cameroon. The female lays her eggs on the muddy riverbed toward the end of the rainy season. Adult fishes die after only one year, leaving the eggs dormant until the next rainy season. The onset of rains stimulates the eggs to develop and hatch. The fishes mature in only one month and quickly repopulate the river.

*Jordanella floridae*

## American-flag fish



**Location** S.E. USA (Florida)

**Length** Up to 3 in  
(7.5 cm)  
**Weight** Not recorded  
**Sex** Male/Female  
**Status** Not evaluated



This fish belongs to the pupfish family—a group of small freshwater fishes that are particularly common in the Americas. Like most pupfishes, the sexes differ in color, and the male's distinctive



pattern and coloration gives the fish its common name. Normally a peaceful eater of algae, the male becomes aggressive during courtship and when guarding eggs. He attracts a female by flashing his red, unpaired fins. After the female has laid her eggs, he drives her away and guards the eggs until they are ready to hatch after about a week.

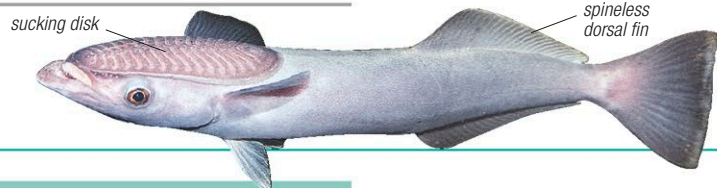
*Remora remora*

## Shark sucker



**Location** Tropical, subtropical, and temperate waters worldwide

**Length** Up to 34 in  
(86 cm)  
**Weight** Up to 2¼ lb  
(1.1 kg)  
**Sex** Male/Female  
**Status** Least concern



Shark suckers, or remoras, are easily identified by the sucking disk above their head, which they use to fasten themselves onto whales, dolphins, and large fish. This species is most often found attached to sharks. The disk enables it to save energy by using the swimming power of its host for locomotion and gill ventilation. The host protects it from predators, and provides food scraps; in return, the shark sucker gleans parasitic crustaceans from the host's skin and gill cavity.

*Nomeus gronovii*

## Man-of-war fish

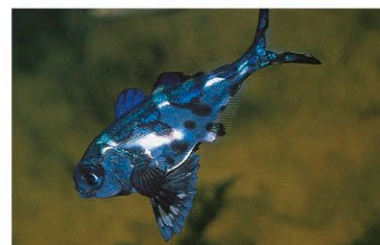


**Location** Tropical waters worldwide

**Length** Up to 10 in  
(25 cm)  
**Weight** Not recorded  
**Sex** Male/Female  
**Status** Least concern



During its early life, this blue-spotted fish often lives among the stinging tentacles of the Portuguese man-of-war (see p.540)—a habit that keeps it beyond the reach of most predators.



Remarkably, it possesses only limited immunity to its host's toxins, and relies on its own swimming ability to avoid being stung. It is known to feed on the tentacles, so it is arguably a parasite of its host. Adults are believed to abandon the relative safety of their hosts for deep waters.

*Caranx hippos*

## Crevalle jack

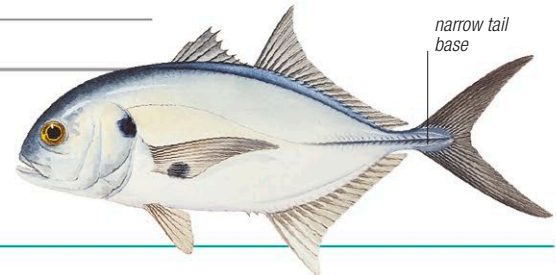


**Location** E. and W. Atlantic

**Length** Up to 4 ft  
(1.2 m)  
**Weight** Up to 71 lb  
(32 kg)  
**Sex** Male/Female  
**Status** Least concern



This fish can be recognized by its large, blunt head, the black spot near the edge of the gill cover, and the



narrow-based, deeply forked tail. The largest of all jack fishes, it can tolerate a broad range of salinities. Juveniles, which congregate in large schools, tend to favour brackish water, while older fishes are found in deeper water, often cruising in pairs. It is an active predator of small fishes: when it attacks a school of baitfishes at the surface, the commotion caused can be seen from a distance.

*Naucrates ductor*

## Pilotfish



**Location** Tropical, subtropical, and temperate waters worldwide

**Length** Up to 70 cm  
(28 in)  
**Weight** Not recorded  
**Sex** Male/Female  
**Status** Least concern



The pilotfish is a small or medium-sized fish with a silvery body marked with 6 or 7 black vertical bands. It gets its name from its habit of swimming just in front of much larger fishes, such as sharks and rays. This arrangement seems to benefit both the pilotfish and its host. The pilotfish feeds on scraps and parasites on sharks and, in turn, benefits from the protection it gets from the larger fish it "pilots;" it also becomes less visible to the smaller fishes on which it preys.

*Coryphaena hippurus*

## Dolphinfish



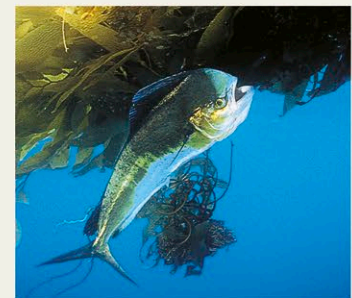
**Location** Tropical, subtropical, and temperate waters worldwide

**Length** Up to 7 ft  
(2.1 m)  
**Weight** Up to 88 lb  
(40 kg)  
**Sex** Male/Female  
**Status** Least concern



Also known as the dorado, this blunt-headed fish has a single dorsal fin stretching along almost the whole length of its elongated body. It also possesses a large, deeply forked tail—a characteristic feature of an oceanic species that relies on speed to catch food and avoid being eaten. It has unusual coloration: a back that is a brilliant metallic blue or green, silvery sides with a golden sheen, and irregular rows of dark or golden spots. An exceptionally rapid swimmer, it can

## FEEDING



The dolphinfish eats mainly fishes, but also crustaceans and squid associated with floating objects. It follows ships and may form small groups below floating sargassum and other seaweed.

reach speeds of 37 mph (60 kph). This prized food fish is generally restricted to waters warmer than 68°F (20°C) and breeds in the open ocean. Spawning occurs at different times depending on location.

## CAMOUFLAGE COLORATION

The countershading on its body helps this fish blend both into the dark depths and the well-lit open sea above, making it invisible to predators approaching from above or below.

